Student Activities
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SPEAKER'S PROFILE AND PRESENTATION OVERVIEW

I. SESSION 1

A. Topic/Title of the Session

Building and Managing AI Systems Workshop

B. Rationale

As artificial intelligence continues to play a growing role across industries, there is an increasing need for students to understand not only how AI models work but also how they are built, managed, and deployed in real-world environments. This workshop is designed to address this need by providing a practical introduction to modern AI systems, with an emphasis on workflow organization, operational efficiency, and deployment strategies.

Many learners face challenges in translating theoretical AI concepts into functional applications, particularly due to the complexity of system pipelines and cloud-based infrastructures. Without proper guidance, these barriers can limit innovation and practical application. This workshop provides participants with opportunities to overcome these challenges by presenting a structured and accessible framework that simplifies the transition from concept to implementation.

By the end of the workshop, participants are expected to gain foundational skills and increased confidence in managing AI workflows and deploying models effectively. These outcomes will enable them to develop scalable and repeatable AI solutions, supporting their academic growth, enhancing career readiness, and contributing to technological innovation.

C. Objectives

1) Understand the core components of modern AI systems, including task organization and workflow design for effective system management.
2) Apply basic deployment techniques by implementing AI models in a cloud environment or within a simple pipeline.
3) Translate AI concepts into practical outputs by following a structured framework that turns initial ideas into functional, repeatable solutions.

D. Speaker's Profile

Name: John Andre Yap

Background:

John Andre Yap is a second-year Computer Science student from the University of San Carlos. He is currently an **AI Engineer Intern at Evo Tech** and **Lead** at **GDG on Campus USC**. He is an AI engineer who specializes in turning chaotic ideas into deployed MVPs. John bridges the gap between theoretical CS and "shipping it." While most developers are still debating best practices, John is orchestrating swarms of AI agents to do the heavy lifting. He maintains his own AI agent suite, a personal library of specialized agents built directly with Claude Code to automate architecture tracing, debugging, and design reviews. He builds systems that "reflect how I actually work rather than how workflows are supposed to look.

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Name: Geri Gian Epanto

Background:

Geri Gian Epanto is a second-year Computer Science student from the University of San Carlos. He is a full-stack architect who specializes in turning AI concepts into robust, scalable platforms. As the **Chief Technology Officer for GDG on Campus USC** and **TechDev Lead for the DOST Scholars' Association**, Gian focuses on the infrastructure that makes AI useful.

His work defines the cutting edge of "Agentic AI." He engineered a financial analysis engine that uses LLM tool-calling to autonomously query SQL databases—effectively teaching AI to be a data analyst. Beyond AI, Geri is a master of the product lifecycle; he architected TRIP, a modernized transit system that handles real-time payments and logistics, and SABOT, a platform with automated AI safety verification. A seasoned competitor, Geri was a finalist representing the Philippines in the Lisk Builders Challenge and secured 1st Runner Up at Cebu Hacktoberfest.

Name: Nick Anthony Miras

Background:

Nick is a 2nd-year Mechanical Engineering student from the University of San Carlos who specializes in bridging the gap between abstract code and physical reality. As the **AI/ML Officer for GDG on Campus US**C and a **Research Intern at CenGES**, he builds systems that don't just exist on a server but interact with the real world.

He has engineered end-to-end solutions ranging from IoT-based flood monitoring networks to complex machine learning pipelines that combine NASA geospatial data with Random Forest classifiers to predict urban flooding and reroute traffic. He once secured a **4th-place** finish in a National Python Competition hosted by De La Salle University against senior undergraduate students.

From designing award-winning bird preservation concepts for the Dyson Award to optimizing embedded hardware costs for freelance clients, Nick builds with a focus on impact, efficiency, and data integrity.